

**CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION****CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET G — FINAL MASTERY & GRAND CHALLENGE TEST (60 MINS)****CHAPTER 04: EARLY HUMANS AND BEGINNING OF CIVILISATION**

TIME ALLOWED: 60 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-G-04

Student's Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Roll No.: \_\_\_\_\_

Class &amp; Section: Class IX - \_\_\_\_\_

Date of Exam: \_\_\_\_\_

Invigilator's Sign: \_\_\_\_\_

**General Instructions (SET G - Final Mastery & Grand Challenge Test):**

1. The question paper comprises **25 Olympiad / NTSE / Advanced Analytical Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Designed for **Final Curricular Mastery & In-Depth Analytical Rigour**: Target time is **60 Minutes**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

 **GRAND CHALLENGE SPECIAL:** This final assessment tests your multi-disciplinary analytical reasoning across historical source criticism, geomorphological dynamics, constitutional jurisprudence, and microeconomic market equilibria!

Q1. What advanced Stone Age lithic technology involved shaping a flint core before detaching a single pre-determined, razor-sharp flake tool with a prepared striking platform?

- ☐ A Acheulean hand-axe chipping ☐ B Levallois technique (prepared-core technique) ☐ C Pebble chopping tool ☐ D Microlithic hafting

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** The Levallois technique (Middle Palaeolithic) demonstrated cognitive planning by pre-shaping cores to strike off standardized flakes.

Q2. Excavations of human skeletal remains from the mature Harappan cemetery at Rakhigarhi, Haryana, with successful ancient DNA (aDNA) sequencing revealed:

- ☐ A 100% Greek Hellenistic genetic ancestry ☐ B Indigenous South Asian hunter-gatherer and Iranian agriculturalist ancestry, with a complete absence of Central Asian Steppe pastoralist genetic markers in the Bronze Age ☐ C Pure Roman gladiatorial genetic ancestry ☐ D Zero DNA preservation due to tropical heat

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Rakhigarhi aDNA (Shinde et al., 2019) disproved the Aryan invasion timeline, showing genetic continuity with indigenous South Asian populations.

Q3. What mathematical relationship governed the Harappan binary weight unit scale, where the standard unit 16 weighed approximately 13.7 grams?

- ☐ A Decimal steps: 1, 10, 100, 1000 ☐ B Geometric doubling sequence: 1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32, 64, 128, 320, 640... where the 16th unit served as the primary commercial standard ☐ C Fibonacci series: 1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8 ☐ D Random arbitrary stone weights without any ratio

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Harappan metrology combined an exact lower binary scale (1 to 64) with upper decimal multiples, standardizing transactions across 1,000 km.

Q4. What specialized, extremely hard metamorphic lithic material was manufactured into specialized micro-drills to perforate carnelian beads at Chanhudaro and Lothal?

- ☐ A Soft limestone ☐ B Ernestite (a rare, ultra-dense metamorphic rock discovered by J. M. Kenoyer) ☐ C Pure lead metal ☐ D Baked clay

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Harappan bead artisans developed specialized constricted micro-drills made of 'Ernestite', a rare metamorphic rock harder than carnelian.

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Q5. How did Harappan pyrotechnologists manufacture the diagnostic etched red-and-white carnelian beads exported to Mesopotamian royal courts?

- ☐ A Painting beads with red berry juice ☐ B Heating natural carnelian to enhance deep ferric-oxide red color, and painting white alkali patterns using potassium carbonate derived from plant ashes followed by secondary firing ☐ C Carving glass beads imported from Venice ☐ D Dipping beads in synthetic red plastic

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Harappan pyrotechnology bleached intricate white patterns onto iron-rich carnelian by applying alkali paste and refiring the gemstone.

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Q6. In the famous 'Pashupati' seal from Mohenjo-daro, which four wild animals surround the central horned seated figure?

- ☐ A Lion, Giraffe, Zebra, and Camel ☐ B Elephant, Tiger, Rhinoceros, and Buffalo (with two antelopes/deer beneath the seat) ☐ C Horse, Cow, Sheep, and Goat ☐ D Bear, Wolf, Fox, and Monkey

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** The Pashupati seal depicts an elephant and tiger on the right, a rhinoceros and buffalo on the left, and two antelopes beneath the seat.

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Q7. What distinct physical feature characterizes the famous steatite bust of the 'Priest-King' excavated at Mohenjo-daro?

- ☐ A A crown of gold feathers and modern eyeglasses ☐ B A neatly trimmed beard, a fillet band around the forehead, and an embroidered shawl worn over the left shoulder leaving the right arm bare with trefoil motifs ☐ C A warrior sword held in both hands ☐ D A horse harness draped across his chest

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** The Priest-King statue wears an embroidered trefoil-patterned shawl over the left shoulder, a forehead fillet, and a groomed beard.

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Q8. What dental pathology observed on human teeth from Mehrgarh provides the world's earliest archaeological evidence of proto-dentistry (in vivo tooth drilling)?

- ☐ A Gold teeth fillings placed in 7000 BCE ☐ B Flint micro-drills used to drill conical cavities into living human molars to remove tooth rot (dating to c. 7000–5500 BCE) ☐ C Teeth carved out of solid iron ☐ D Zero dental teeth found

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Microscopic dental analysis on Mehrgarh skeletons revealed 11 molars precisely drilled with flint micro-drills to relieve tooth decay.

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Q9. Which site in the Kachi plain documented the botanical transition from two-row wild hulled barley to six-row naked domesticated barley alongside zebu cattle domestication?

- ☐ A Harappa ☐ B Mehrgarh (Period I and II) ☐ C Taxila ☐ D Bhimbetka

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Mehrgarh's deep stratigraphy provided the botanical evidence of cereal domestication (six-row naked barley) in South Asia.

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Q10. What is the archaeological term for the artificial raised platforms of sun-dried mud bricks upon which Harappan Citadels were constructed?

- ☐ A Ziggurats ☐ B Monumental mud-brick retaining platforms constructed to elevate public structures above recurrent river flood levels ☐ C Pyramids ☐ D Megalithic stone dolmens

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Harappan Citadels were erected on massive elevated mud-brick podiums to protect elite civic structures from perennial monsoon inundations.

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Q11. What unique sanitary feature was discovered inside the residential houses of Mohenjo-daro and Lothal connected directly to exterior drain pipes?

- ☐ A Solid gold flush toilets with modern electronic buttons ☐ B Paved brick bathing platforms and commode latrines with chutes leading to terracotta pipes in the exterior wall ☐ C Open holes leading into living room bedrooms ☐ D No toilets existed anywhere in the ancient city

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Houses featured paved brick bathing stalls and latrines with sloping discharge chutes feeding covered street sewer mains.

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Q12. Why is the Harappan script believed to have been written in the 'Boustrophedon' style in multi-line inscriptions?

- ☐ A It was written only from bottom to top ☐ B The direction of writing alternated from line to line: the first line was written right-to-left, and the subsequent line was written left-to-right (as an ox plows a field) ☐ C It was written in circular spirals only ☐ D It was written exclusively in mirror image

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Boustrophedon ('as the ox turns') describes inscriptions where text alternates direction in successive lines.

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Q13. What raw material was used by Harappans to manufacture synthetic, vitrified, glassy blue-green paste beads and figurines?

- ☐ A Faience (silica powder, fluxes, and copper colorants fired at high temperatures) ☐ B Plastic resin ☐ C Natural emerald gemstones ☐ D Polished aluminium

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Harappan faience was a synthetic pyrotechnological material made by fusing crushed quartz silica with alkali fluxes and copper glazes.

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Q14. What archaeological evidence found at Kalibangan and Banawali demonstrates that Harappans possessed wheeled transportation?

- ☐ A Modern steam locomotives buried under the sand ☐ B Terracotta toy models of two-wheeled bullock carts with solid wheels, alongside cart rut tracks in street alluvium matching modern cart track widths ☐ C Steel bicycles with rubber tires ☐ D Hovercrafts carved onto stone tablets

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Terracotta models of bullock carts and preserved cart ruts matching the gauge of modern bullock carts prove wheeled transport.

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Q15. The discovery of a double burial (a male and a female skeleton interred together in a single brick-lined grave) was unearthed at which Harappan site?

- ☐ A Mohenjo-daro ☐ B Lothal ☐ C Dholavira ☐ D Chanhudaro

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Lothal's cemetery yielded unique joint/double burials where two individuals were buried together in a single grave pit.

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Q16. Which Harappan city featured monumental fortification walls built of solid limestone blocks up to 7 meters thick, punctuated with grand entry gates?

- ☐ A Dholavira ☐ B Chanhudaro ☐ C Alamgirpur ☐ D Kot Diji

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Dholavira's fortifications were constructed of massive dressed stone blocks, unique among Harappan cities.

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Q17. What was the purpose of the perforated cylindrical terracotta jars found abundantly in Harappan excavations?

- ☐ A Serving as musical trumpets ☐ B Used as strainers or presses for fermenting and brewing alcoholic beverages or processing dairy curds ☐ C Used as flower pots for decorative gardens ☐ D Used to catch rainwater from rooftops

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Perforated jars were utilized as functional sieves/strainers, likely in the fermentation of beverages or pressing curds.

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Q18. What paleoclimatic event around 4200 BP (c. 2200 BCE) caused global megadroughts that contributed to the collapse of the Old Kingdom in Egypt, the Akkadian Empire in Mesopotamia, and the Harappan Civilisation?

- ☐ A The 4.2k Year BP Aridification Event (abrupt climatic drought and weakened monsoon circulation) ☐ B A sudden advance of the Little Ice Age ☐ C A volcanic winter caused by Mount Krakatoa ☐ D A sudden cooling of the Earth to absolute zero

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** The 4.2k BP aridification event triggered multi-century droughts across Afro-Eurasia, undermining the agricultural surplus of Bronze Age empires.

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Q19. Which Harappan site in Haryana is recognized as the largest Harappan city in geographic area (spanning over 350 hectares), surpassing Mohenjo-daro?

- ☐ A Banawali ☐ B Rakhigarhi ☐ C Mitathal ☐ D Kunal

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Rakhigarhi in Hisar district, Haryana, is now confirmed as the largest Harappan urban site by total surface extent.

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Q20. What unique architectural feature was discovered at Banawali in Haryana regarding Harappan street planning?

- ☐ A A radial street pattern resembling a star rather than a rigid rectangular gridiron ☐ B Streets built entirely out of glass ☐ C Underground subways with electric trains ☐ D Circular canals surrounding every house

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Banawali exhibited a radial street network diverging outward from the center, departing from the typical strict orthogonal gridiron.

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Q21. What diagnostic ceramic ware characterized by a lustrous, glassy black surface and exceptional hardness emerged in the 1st millennium BCE across North India?

- ☐ A Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP) ☐ B Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW) ☐ C Painted Grey Ware (PGW) ☐ D Black and Red Ware (BRW)

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW) was a high-status, mirror-like ceramic associated with the Second Urbanisation and the rise of Mahajanapadas.

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Q22. Which ceramic culture, associated with early iron metallurgy in the Gangetic plains, preceded Northern Black Polished Ware (c. 1200–600 BCE)?

- ☐ A Painted Grey Ware (PGW) ☐ B Harappan Red Ware ☐ C Neolithic Corded Ware ☐ D Microlithic Flints

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Painted Grey Ware (PGW), discovered at Hastinapur and Kurukshetra, represents the material culture of the Later Vedic era and early iron usage.

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Q23. What is 'Cire Perdue'?

- ☐ A An ancient Greek dessert recipe ☐ B The lost-wax casting process used to create intricate hollow or solid bronze metallic sculptures ☐ C A method of ploughing agricultural fields with horses ☐ D A type of rock-cut temple architecture

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Cire perdue (lost-wax casting) is the metallurgical technique used to cast the Harappan Dancing Girl and Chola bronzes.

Q24. In the Mesolithic rock art of Bhimbetka, which artistic convention was used to depict animals with their internal organs visible inside their bodies?

- ☐ A Cubism ☐ B X-ray style painting (showing heart, lungs, or pregnant fetuses inside animal silhouettes) ☐ C Impressionism ☐ D Pointillism

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Prehistoric hunters rendered animals in the 'X-ray style', painting internal organs, gastrointestinal tracts, and unborn young.

Q25. What is the primary conclusion drawn by modern archaeologists regarding the political structure of the Mature Harappan Civilisation?

- ☐ A It was ruled by a single bloodthirsty military tyrant who executed all citizens daily ☐ B The extraordinary standardization of weights, bricks, urban layouts, and seals indicates centralized civic authority, administrative coordination, and trade councils, without evidence of ostentatious royal tombs or military standing armies ☐ C There was zero government and every family lived in anarchy ☐ D It was ruled by foreign Roman governors

**Scholarly Concept & Analysis:** Remarkable standardization across a million square kilometers points to centralized civic institutions and merchant oligarchies without military despotism.

#### CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET G)

|            |            |            |            |            |
|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
| 01 A B C D | 02 A B C D | 03 A B C D | 04 A B C D | 05 A B C D |
| 06 A B C D | 07 A B C D | 08 A B C D | 09 A B C D | 10 A B C D |
| 11 A B C D | 12 A B C D | 13 A B C D | 14 A B C D | 15 A B C D |
| 16 A B C D | 17 A B C D | 18 A B C D | 19 A B C D | 20 A B C D |
| 21 A B C D | 22 A B C D | 23 A B C D | 24 A B C D | 25 A B C D |

Total Questions Attempted: \_\_\_\_ / 25

Marks Obtained: \_\_\_\_ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: \_\_\_\_\_

### OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & IN-DEPTH SCHOLARLY EXPLANATIONS (SET G)

| Q. No. | Correct | Curricular Concept & Scholarly Analysis                                                                                                           |
|--------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1      | B       | The Levallois technique (Middle Palaeolithic) demonstrated cognitive planning by pre-shaping cores to strike off standardized flakes.             |
| 2      | B       | Rakhigarhi aDNA (Shinde et al., 2019) disproved the Aryan invasion timeline, showing genetic continuity with indigenous South Asian populations.  |
| 3      | B       | Harappan metrology combined an exact lower binary scale (1 to 64) with upper decimal multiples, standardizing transactions across 1,000 km.       |
| 4      | B       | Harappan bead artisans developed specialized constricted micro-drills made of 'Ernestite', a rare metamorphic rock harder than carnelian.         |
| 5      | B       | Harappan pyrotechnology bleached intricate white patterns onto iron-rich carnelian by applying alkali paste and refiring the gemstone.            |
| 6      | B       | The Pashupati seal depicts an elephant and tiger on the right, a rhinoceros and buffalo on the left, and two antelopes beneath the seat.          |
| 7      | B       | The Priest-King statue wears an embroidered trefoil-patterned shawl over the left shoulder, a forehead fillet, and a groomed beard.               |
| 8      | B       | Microscopic dental analysis on Mehrgarh skeletons revealed 11 molars precisely drilled with flint micro-drills to relieve tooth decay.            |
| 9      | B       | Mehrgarh's deep stratigraphy provided the botanical evidence of cereal domestication (six-row naked barley) in South Asia.                        |
| 10     | B       | Harappan Citadels were erected on massive elevated mud-brick podiums to protect elite civic structures from perennial monsoon inundations.        |
| 11     | B       | Houses featured paved brick bathing stalls and latrines with sloping discharge chutes feeding covered street sewer mains.                         |
| 12     | B       | Boustrophedon ('as the ox turns') describes inscriptions where text alternates direction in successive lines.                                     |
| 13     | A       | Harappan faience was a synthetic pyrotechnological material made by fusing crushed quartz silica with alkali fluxes and copper glazes.            |
| 14     | B       | Terracotta models of bullock carts and preserved cart ruts matching the gauge of modern bullock carts prove wheeled transport.                    |
| 15     | B       | Lothal's cemetery yielded unique joint/double burials where two individuals were buried together in a single grave pit.                           |
| 16     | A       | Dholavira's fortifications were constructed of massive dressed stone blocks, unique among Harappan cities.                                        |
| 17     | B       | Perforated jars were utilized as functional sieves/strainers, likely in the fermentation of beverages or pressing curds.                          |
| 18     | A       | The 4.2k BP aridification event triggered multi-century droughts across Afro-Eurasia, undermining the agricultural surplus of Bronze Age empires. |
| 19     | B       | Rakhigarhi in Hisar district, Haryana, is now confirmed as the largest Harappan urban site by total surface extent.                               |
| 20     | A       | Banawali exhibited a radial street network diverging outward from the center, departing from the typical strict orthogonal gridiron.              |

| Q. No. | Correct | Curricular Concept & Scholarly Analysis                                                                                                                     |
|--------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 21     | B       | Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW) was a high-status, mirror-like ceramic associated with the Second Urbanisation and the rise of Mahajanapadas.           |
| 22     | A       | Painted Grey Ware (PGW), discovered at Hastinapur and Kurukshetra, represents the material culture of the Later Vedic era and early iron usage.             |
| 23     | B       | Cire perdue (lost-wax casting) is the metallurgical technique used to cast the Harappan Dancing Girl and Chola bronzes.                                     |
| 24     | B       | Prehistoric hunters rendered animals in the 'X-ray style', painting internal organs, gastrointestinal tracts, and unborn young.                             |
| 25     | B       | Remarkable standardization across a million square kilometers points to centralized civic institutions and merchant oligarchies without military despotism. |